

PURPOSE: To allow students to be absent from classes on the day of their AP Exam if they have teacher approval or an average of 85 or higher in each class missed.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

The Mississippi School for Mathematics and Sciences is known for its large variety of classes, many of these being Advanced Placement courses. As commonly known, most students who take these courses also take the AP Exam near the end of the academic year, a cumulative exam that can earn college credit across the nation. The average AP exam is not only rigorous, but also lasts a total of 2-3 hours, easily requiring a great amount of mental energy.

Some AP Exams occur at 12:00 p.m. on school days, yet students are still required to attend their classes beforehand. These students might also have tests or quizzes prior to the exam, draining mental energy that could instead be devoted towards this exam.

Because of the importance of these exams and the danger of mental fatigue, MSMS should allow for students to be absent from their morning classes before their AP Exam.

Other AP Exams occur at 8:00 a.m. Students should also be allowed to be exempt from classes after their AP exam due to the possibility of a lower performance on tests and quizzes from mental fatigue caused by the exam. Other standardized tests, like the PSAT, ACT, and state tests allow for students to be entirely absent from classes that day. For this, it is only reasonable if the same applies for students who are taking the AP exam that day.

Yet missing class that day might also prove to be detrimental to students' class grades, therefore students must show that they have an adequate performance in their courses. To do this, these students must have an average of 85 or higher in the classes they are missing. Teachers might also have issues putting grades in, possibly resulting in an average that might not reflect the student's true performance in the class. To compensate for this, teacher approval can also be used to exempt students from said class.

SECTION TWO (RESPONSES):

Response 1 (Langston Smith):

"I think if I had time to mentally prepare for the exam I'd probably do a lot better. Going through classes before it would definitely exhaust me"

Response 2 (Anonymous):

“If I pay so much money for the AP Exam, it doesn’t seem reasonable to lower my chances of scoring higher on either the AP Exam (for the afternoon AP Exam) or tests I have in class (for the morning AP Exam).”

Response 3 (Ava Bodmer)

“Because we are going to be so exhausted after an AP test, I feel like we should be allowed to be absent after the exam is finished.”